



GRIMES COUNTY BUDGET HEARINGS

OFFICIAL MINUTES — THURSDAY, JULY 30, 2026

The Grimes County Budget Hearings met on Thursday, July 30, 2026, at 9:00 A.M. Members Present: County Judge Joe Fauth, Commissioner Chad Mallett, Commissioner David Tullos, Commissioner Michael Raska, Commissioner Phillip Cox.

County Judge Joe Fauth called the meeting to order.

Discuss and review the Grimes County FY 2027 departmental budget requests. — Joe Fauth III

County Judge Joe Fauth opened the departmental budget review meeting and provided an overview of the proposed budget, which included a \$4 per hour increase for all employees including elected officials and department heads, with minimums of \$15 per hour for temporary employees, \$20 per hour for part-time employees, and \$20 per hour for full-time employees. The court reviewed budgets for multiple departments throughout the day, beginning with the District Clerk's office. Diane LeFlore District Clerk requested consideration for salary adjustments to bring her office closer in alignment with similar county positions, noting she had lost five dedicated employees to other offices partly due to compensation gaps. She also addressed overtime needs, citing upcoming trials, and discussed supplies, postage, and dues renewal fees. County Judge Joe Fauth acknowledged the complexity of comparing salaries across departments with different funding sources, particularly those with Senate Bill 22 funding. The discussion proceeded through operational expenses including office supplies, postage, and various line items, with adjustments made based on current spending patterns and anticipated needs. The court also examined the IT department's extensive software budget of approximately \$1.2 million, which County Judge Joe Fauth noted was necessary for county operations despite its size. IT Director Gregg Cannon presented numerous software requests and discussed cybersecurity initiatives, including multi-factor authentication and email protection measures, while addressing concerns raised by Commissioner Phillip Cox about monitoring software usage to ensure efficiency. The court reviewed requests from the Emergency Management and Fire Marshal office, including equipment needs and personnel requests for growth management. County Treasurer Tom Maynard presented the treasurer's budget, which included discussion of a new timekeeping software system, and the Tax Assessor/Collector Mary Ann Waters presented her budget with requests for equipment replacement and records preservation. The court also discussed Human Resources office needs and a proposed title change for a senior administrative assistant to executive assistant with responsibilities as benefits coordinator. Substantial time was devoted to the Road Department budget under County Engineer Jon Steiber's direction, which included discussion of restructuring environmental permits and inspections as a separate department, moving certain personnel, requesting additional development technicians to handle growth in residential and commercial development, and addressing equipment needs including vehicles and bridge projects. The court examined grant-funded projects, capital improvements, and discussed the aging equipment fleet requiring replacement. County Auditor Jessi Murphy provided a summary of changes recommended and confirmed tax rate information, noting preliminary calculations for the no-new-revenue rate and voter approval rate, with plans to provide detailed information for court review before the August 7 rate-setting meeting.

ADJOURNMENT

A motion to adjourn the meeting was made, seconded, and carried. The meeting adjourned at 2:39 PM.

Motion by Commissioner Raska to Adjourn. Seconded by Commissioner Mallett. Carried (5-0-0)

THE OFFICIAL MINUTES OF THE GRIMES COUNTY BUDGET HEARINGS ON July 30th, 2026, ARE HEREBY APPROVED.

Barbara Kimich County Clerk